CASE STUDY · 2026

Identity work

Three brand identities from the first sketch
to the brandbook, and two smaller studies.







CONTENTS

In this case study

01 How I work
Brief to brandbook, in five steps 03

02 Fold Supply
A square folded on its diagonal 04

03 Fine.
Gold bars hidden in the letters 14

04 Notch
Letters cut like a paper pattern 24

05 Smaller studies
Aha! and a family honey brand 32

06 What I can make for you 34

FOLD SUPPLY

Work turns back into home 05
I started again 06
A folded full stop 07
Rules that keep it a signature 08
Every colour is a material 09
A sans that names, a serif that explains 10
Each product, at work and put away 11
The box seal is the logo 12
18 pages, plus an asset pack 13

FINE.

Safe enough to read in three seconds 15
Starting wide 16
Separate bars, held together 17
The F, rebuilt 18
A bar in every letter 19
The reveal 20
Lockups and stacking 21
The brand on one sheet 22
Light, not a flat yellow 23

NOTCH

Start from the pair you love 25
Round one wasn't it 26
Three directions 27
Cut, not drawn 28
New colours, and a drawing you can trust 29
The pattern bundle 30
The hem index catalogue 31

© 2026. All rights reserved.

01

How I work

I design brand identities: the logo, and the system that lets it work on a box, a phone screen and a 16 px favicon.

Each brand in this case study started from a brief I wrote myself, the way a client would send one. All three are concept brands. The products are fictional and nothing is for sale.

01

Brief

I write down who the brand is for, what it sells and how it should feel.

02

Explore

Several logo routes, typefaces and palettes, side by side on boards.

03

One idea

I pick one small detail the whole brand can grow from.

04

System

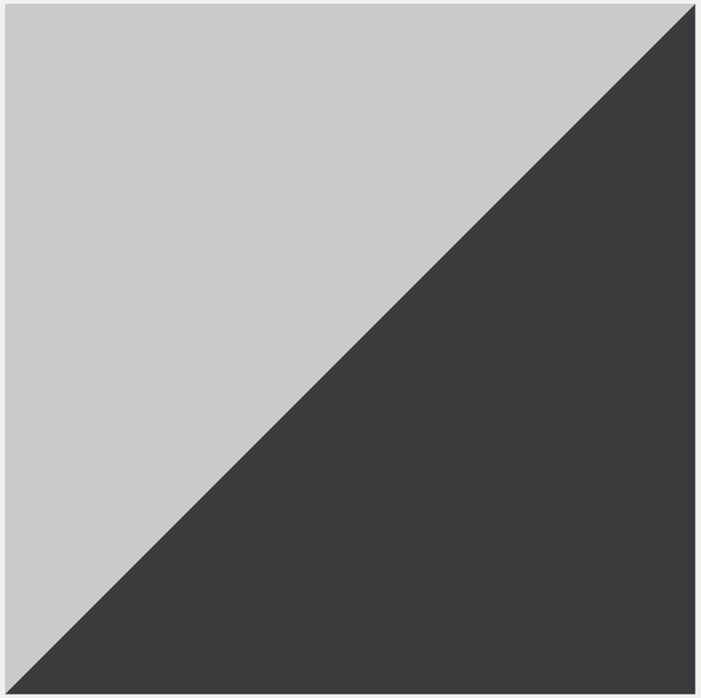
Colour, type, icons, motion and print, each checked at real sizes.

05

Rules

A brandbook and an asset pack, so anyone can use the brand without me.

© 2026. All rights reserved.



The detail it all grew from: one folded corner.

02

Fold Supply

Desk accessories for people who work from home. The logo is a square folded on its diagonal.

Fold Supply.

BRIEF
Self-initiated

PRODUCTS
Desk mat, folding laptop stand, cable clips

I MADE
Logo, colour, type, 12 icons, motion, packaging, 18-page brandbook, asset pack

YEAR
2026

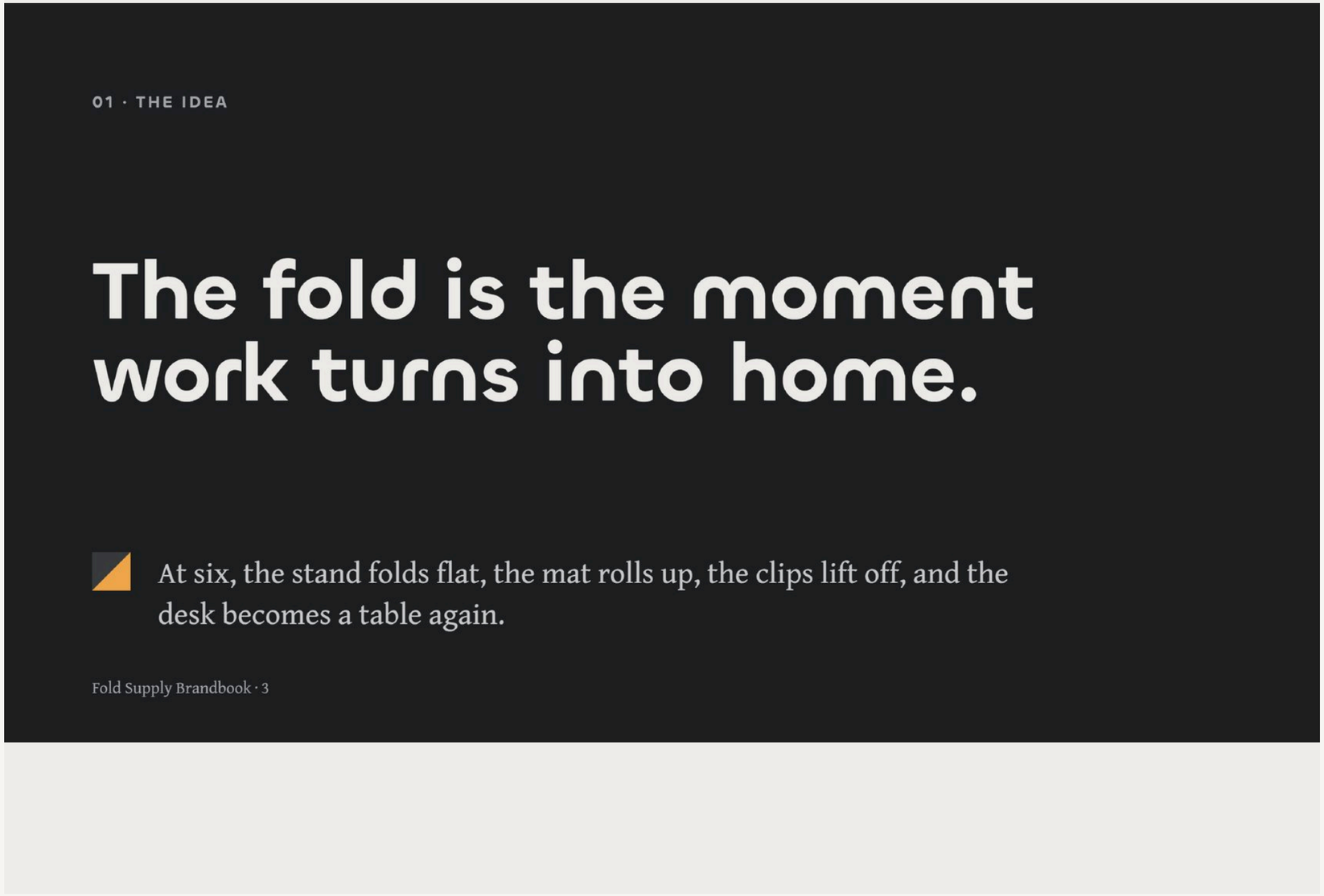
© 2026. All rights reserved.

THE BRIEF

Work turns back into home

I gave myself a brief for a small shop with three things: a felt desk mat, a folding laptop stand and a pair of cable clips.

The people buying them work at a kitchen table or in a corner of the bedroom. At six the stand folds flat, the mat rolls up and the desk is a table again. So the brand is about putting work away.



Brandbook page 3: the idea

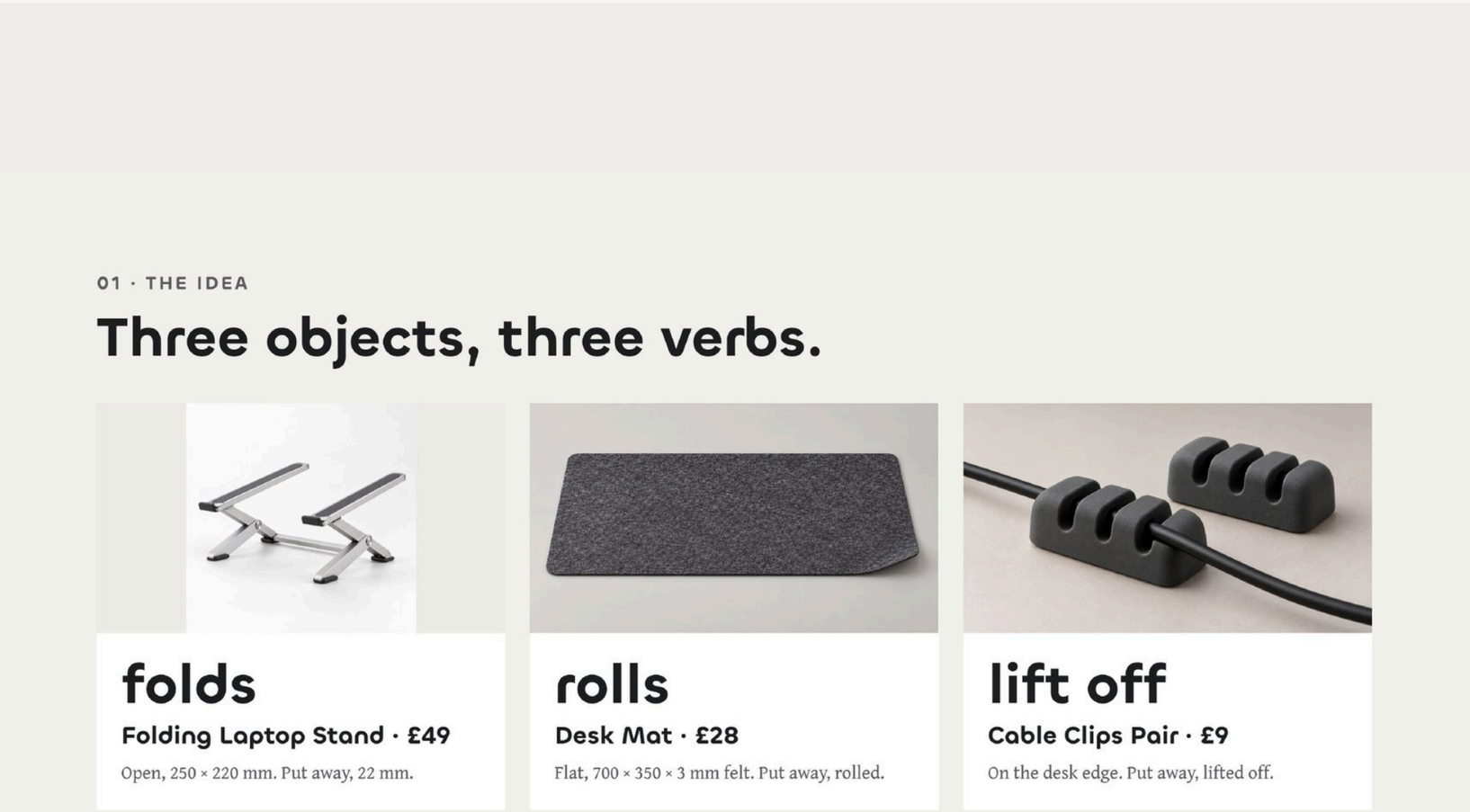
© 2026. All rights reserved.

PROCESS

I started again

My first route was a tape-measure identity with a red accent and a 3D site built around it. Put together, it was too much for three small objects.

I dropped it and made a quieter round: stacked wordmarks, small product icons and a handful of fold marks. One of the fold marks became the logo.



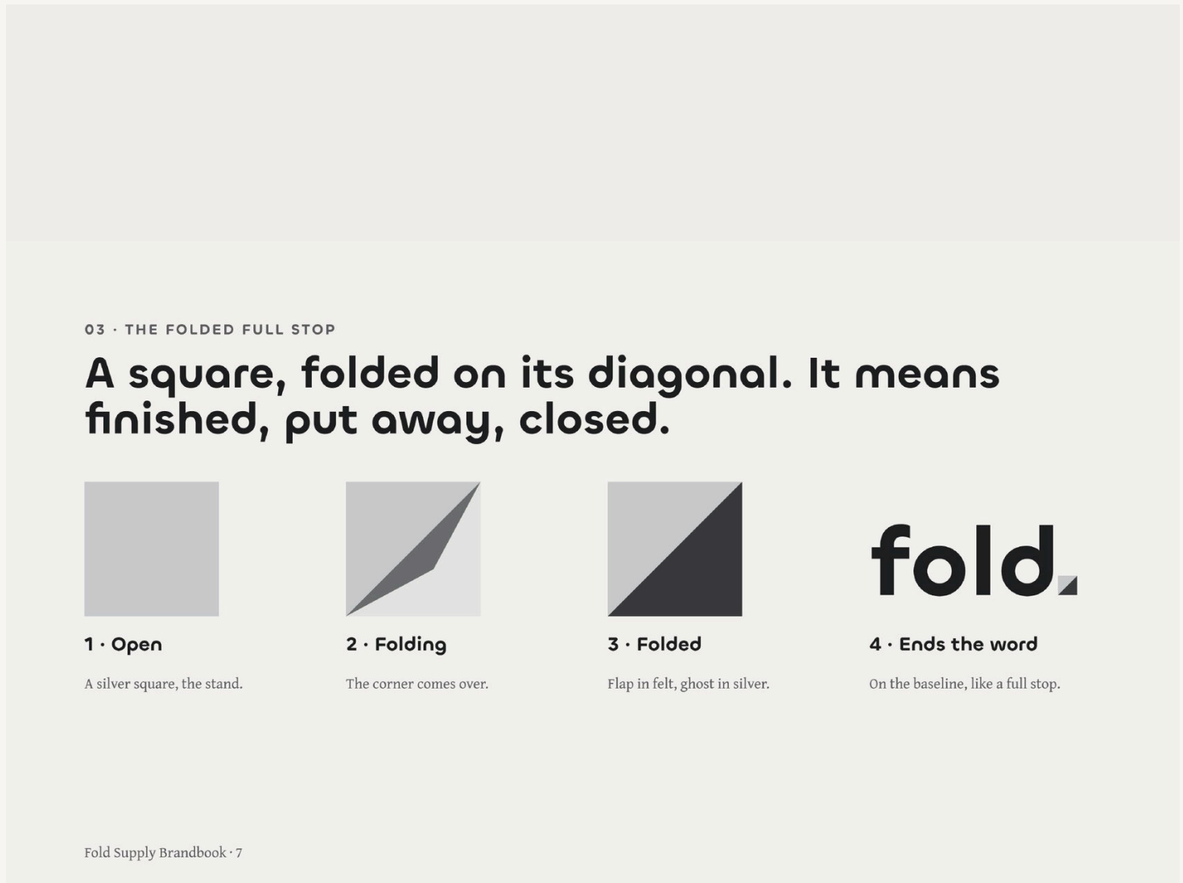
Three objects, three verbs

© 2026. All rights reserved.

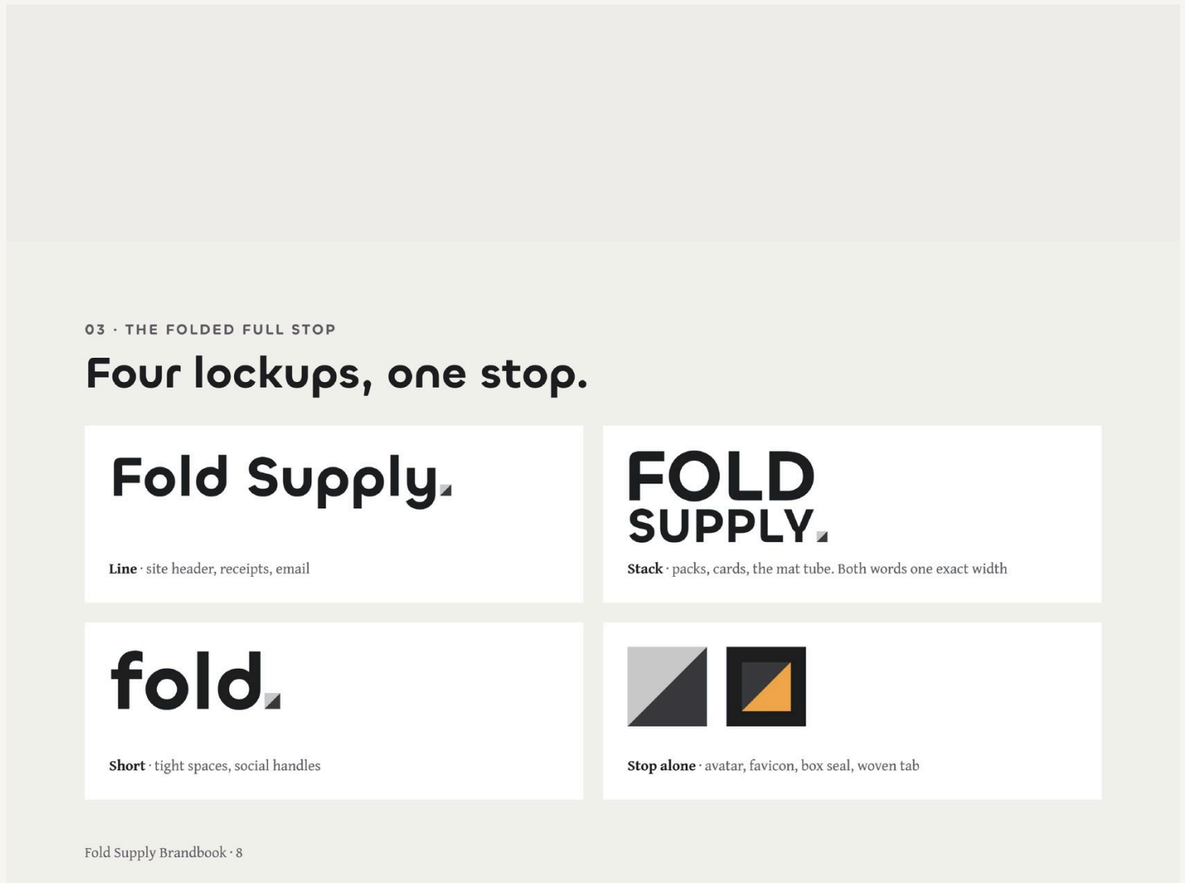
THE MARK

A folded full stop

A square folded on its diagonal, set on the baseline like a full stop. In this brand it means done: the stand is folded, the box is closed. It ends every brand line, and there is only ever one per surface.



Open, folding, folded, then it ends the word



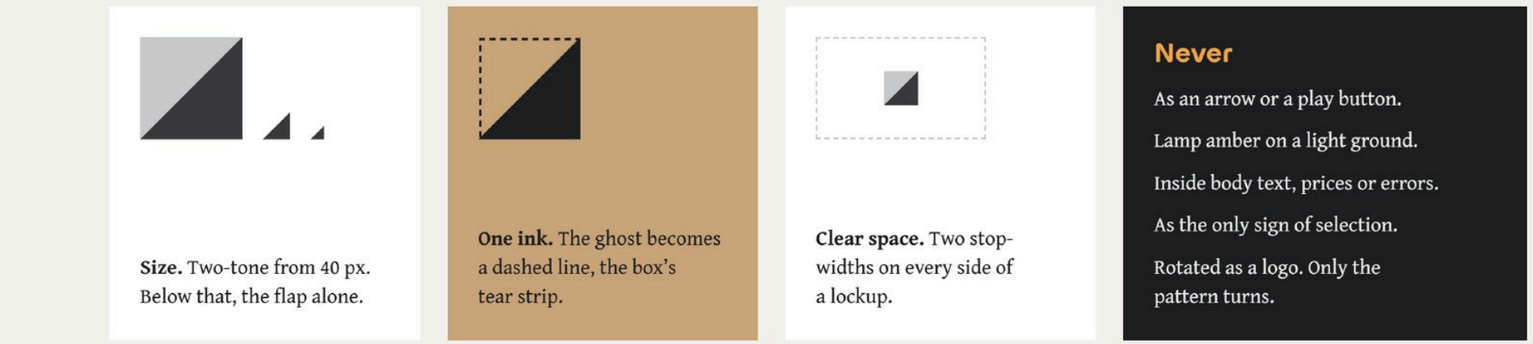
Four lockups share the one stop

© 2026. All rights reserved.

THE MARK

Rules that keep it a signature

The stop never turns into an arrow or a bullet, and it never sits inside body text. Amber only goes on graphite, because on a light ground it drops below a readable contrast.



Rules for the stop

© 2026. All rights reserved.

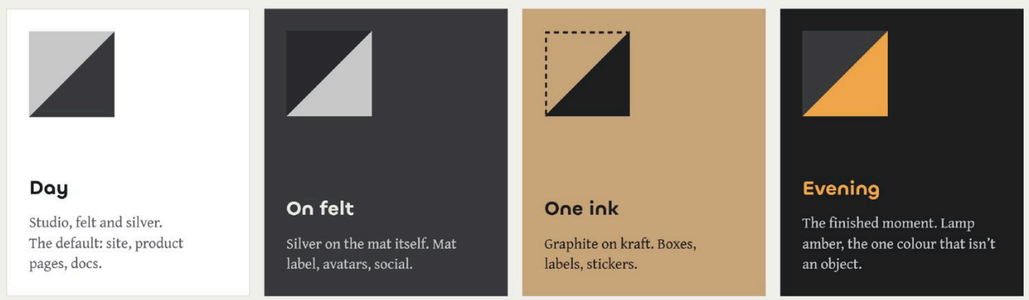
COLOUR

Every colour is a material

I took the colours from the products: graphite felt, silver aluminium and the brown kraft of the box. Lamp amber is the one colour that isn't an object. It's the desk lamp at the end of the day, and it only sits on graphite, at 8.1 : 1.

04 · COLOUR

Every colour is a material. Four surfaces, one family.



Fold Supply Brandbook · 10

Four surfaces, one family

04 · COLOUR

The palette, and where each colour comes from.



Ratios are WCAG contrast against the day ground, or the ground named. Lamp never sits on a light ground (1.8 : 1). Focus blue #0A5CD6, error #B42318 and positive #146C43 are functional only.

Fold Supply Brandbook · 11

The palette and where each colour comes from

© 2026. All rights reserved.

TYPE AND VOICE

A sans that names, a serif that explains

Chillax for names and headings, Gentium Book Plus for reading. Both are free fonts, so a small shop can use them without a licence bill. The voice is plain, with numbers before adjectives.

05 · TYPOGRAPHY

A wide sans that names. A book serif that explains.

Make room

Chillax 600 · display

Names, headlines, labels, buttons. Wide, open, friendly. ITF Free Font Licence, via Fontshare.

Opens to a 250 × 220 mm footprint and folds down to 22 mm when work's done. Spot clean with a lightly damp cloth, then let the mat dry flat.

£49 · £76

Gentium Book Plus · body and prices

Reading text, specs, prices (Chillax has no tabular figures). SIL Open Font Licence, via Google Fonts.

Fold Supply Brandbook · 13 · Web scale: 72 / 56 / 32 / 22 Chillax · 17 / 15 / 13 Gentium · price 28 bold

Typography

02 · VOICE

Plain, measured, a little warm. Numbers before adjectives.

Write	Not
Folds to 22 mm when work's done.	The ultimate space-saving solution.
Fits 13 to 15.6 in laptops. Check the base sits across both rails.	Fits all laptops!
Only 2 stands left. Choose 2 or fewer.	Oops! Something went wrong.
That's work done.	Order successful!!

Brand lines end with the folded full stop. Body copy keeps ordinary full stops.

Fold Supply Brandbook · 6

Voice: write this, not that

© 2026. All rights reserved.

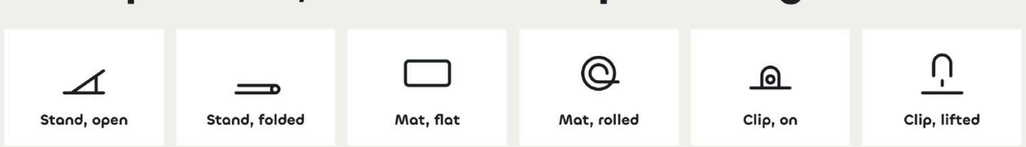
ICONS AND MOTION

Each product, at work and put away

Twelve icons on a 48 px grid with a 2.5 px stroke. Each product is drawn twice, in use and put away. The brand has one animation, the fold, and it takes 240 ms.

06 · ICONS AND LINES

Each product, at work and put away.



Valley fold. Section breaks, the box tear strip.

Mountain fold. Card edges, the bag drawer.

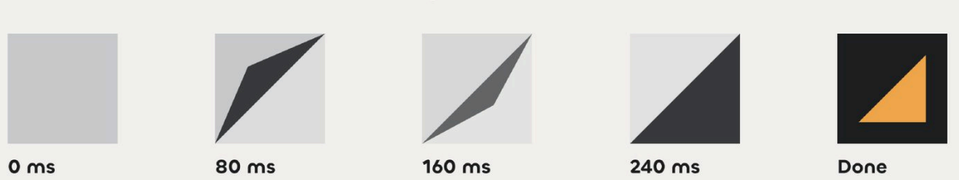
Crease. When something folds away, its dashed line turns solid.

Fold Supply Brandbook · 14 · 48 px grid, 2.5 px stroke, round caps, no fills. Benefit icons in the design system.

Icons and fold lines

07 · MOTION

One move: the fold, in 240 ms.



Stand added to your bag

Plays for added to bag, order placed, form sent. Reduced motion: it swaps. Prices and Add to bag never move.

Fold Supply Brandbook · 15 · The fold line: on long pages a crease moves down with the scroll, and below it the page is in the Evening theme.

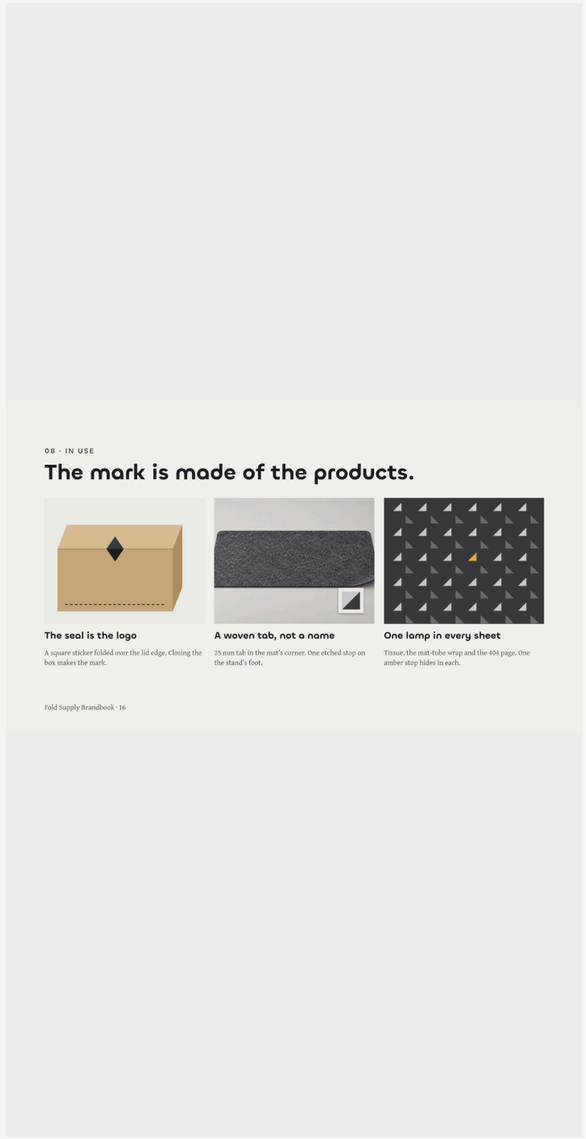
One move: the fold

© 2026. All rights reserved.

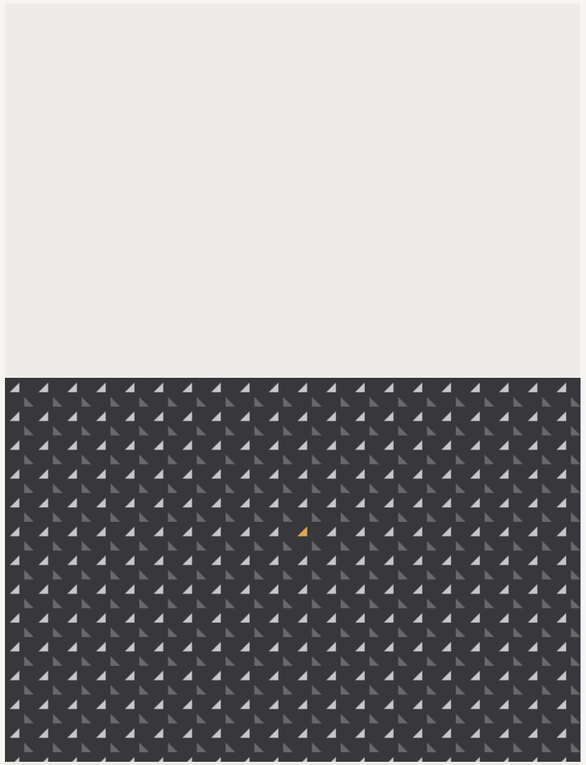
IN USE

The box seal is the logo

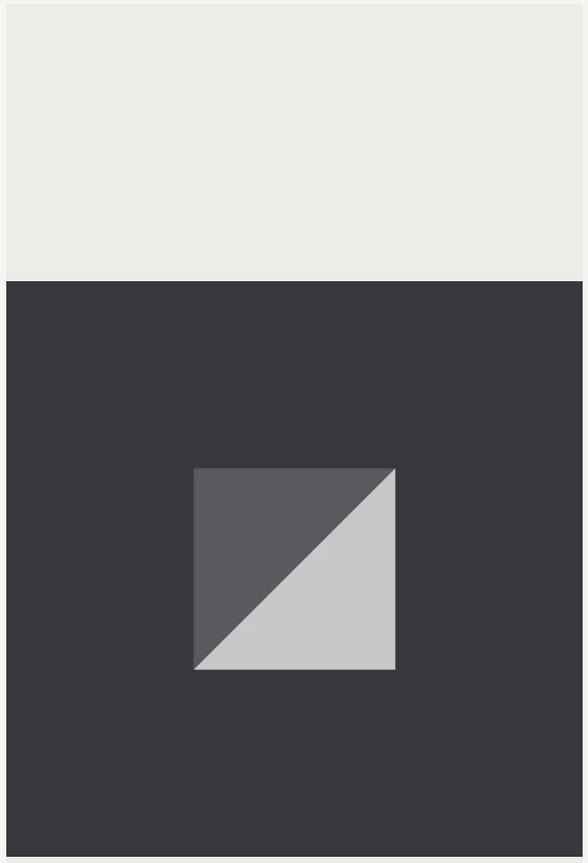
Closing the box makes the mark. The tissue paper hides one amber stop in its pattern, and the social avatars come in a day and an evening version.



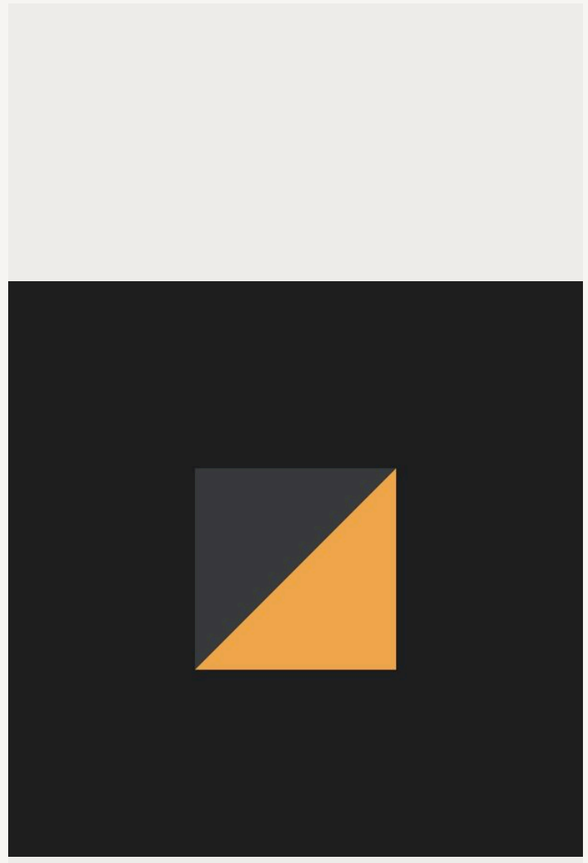
The mark is made of the products



Tissue sheet with one amber stop



Avatar, day



Avatar, evening

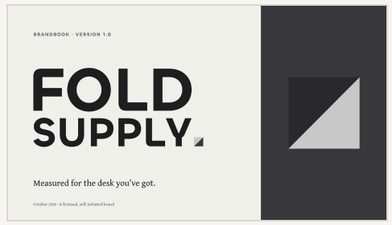
© 2026. All rights reserved.

THE BRANDBOOK

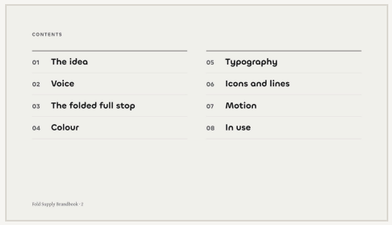
18 pages, plus an asset pack

The brandbook covers the idea, voice, the stop and its rules, colour, type, icons, motion and the brand in use. With it I packed 40 SVG and 105 PNG files: logos, favicons, avatars, icons, the tissue pattern and colour swatches, with a short readme.

What I learned: starting over cost me a few days, but the quieter route was the one that still worked as a 16 px favicon.



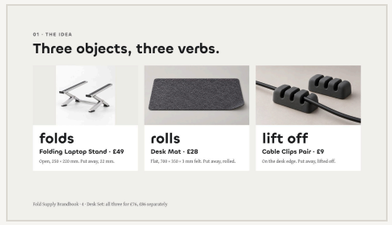
01



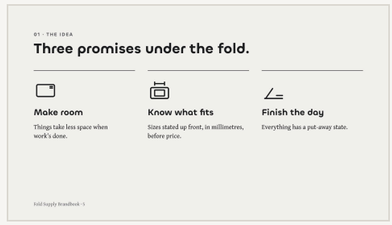
02



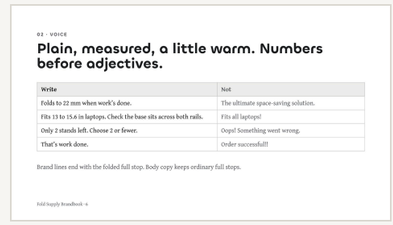
03



04



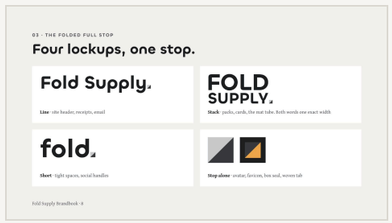
05



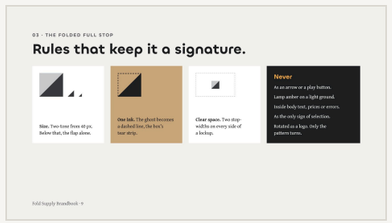
06



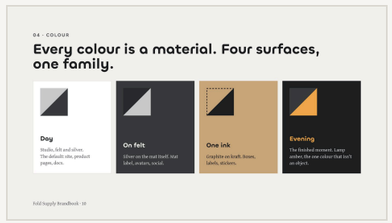
07



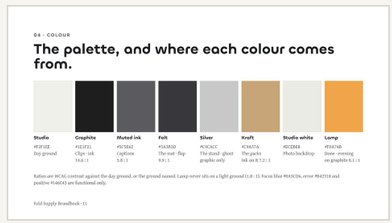
08



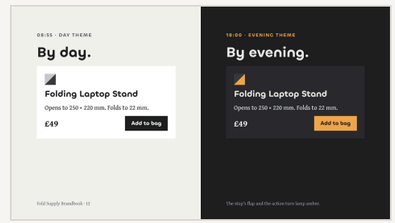
09



10



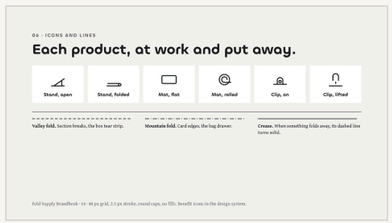
11



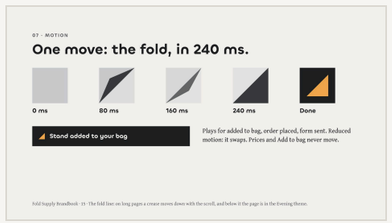
12



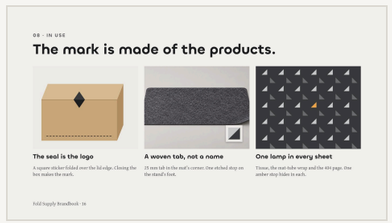
13



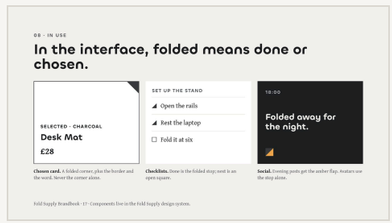
14



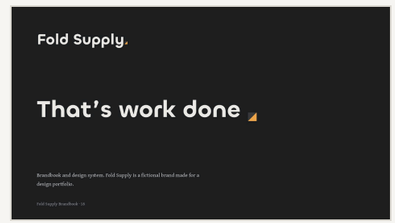
15



16



17



18

© 2026. All rights reserved.

03

Fine.

A gold-buying app for people buying their first few grams. Every serif in the wordmark is a gold bar.



The detail it all grew from: one gold bar.

FINE.

BRIEF
Self-initiated

PRODUCT
An app for buying and storing gold in grams

I MADE
Wordmark, F icon, colour, type, gold as a material, motion, foil for print

YEAR
2026

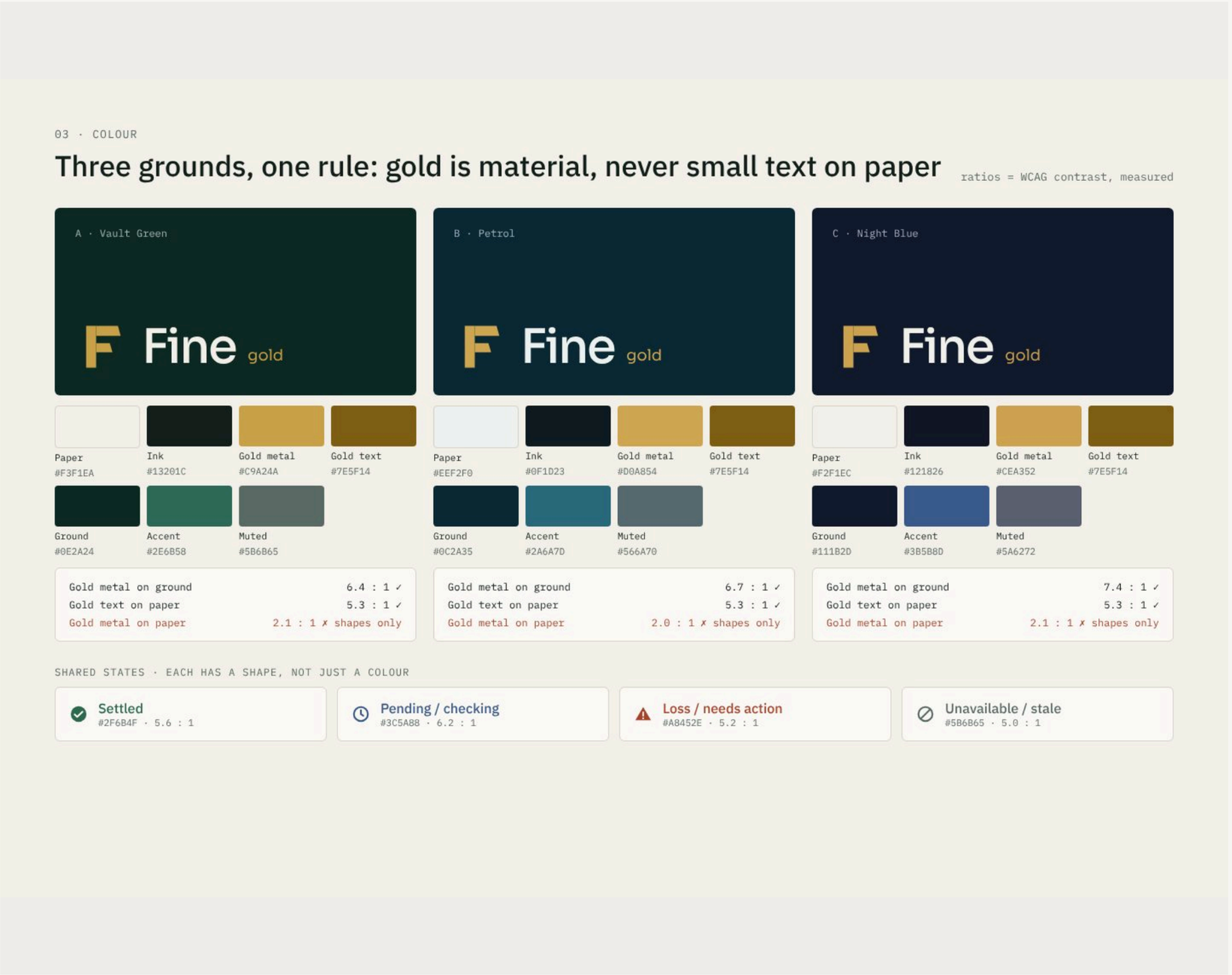
© 2026. All rights reserved.

THE BRIEF

Safe enough to read in three seconds

The brief: an app where someone with a small budget buys real gold by the gram, keeps it stored, and can take a bar home when they want one.

I first called it Held Gold, then Fine Gold, and in the end just Fine. The people I had in mind are careful with money, so the brand had to look premium and trustworthy, and its ideas had to land in two or three seconds.



Three grounds with gold

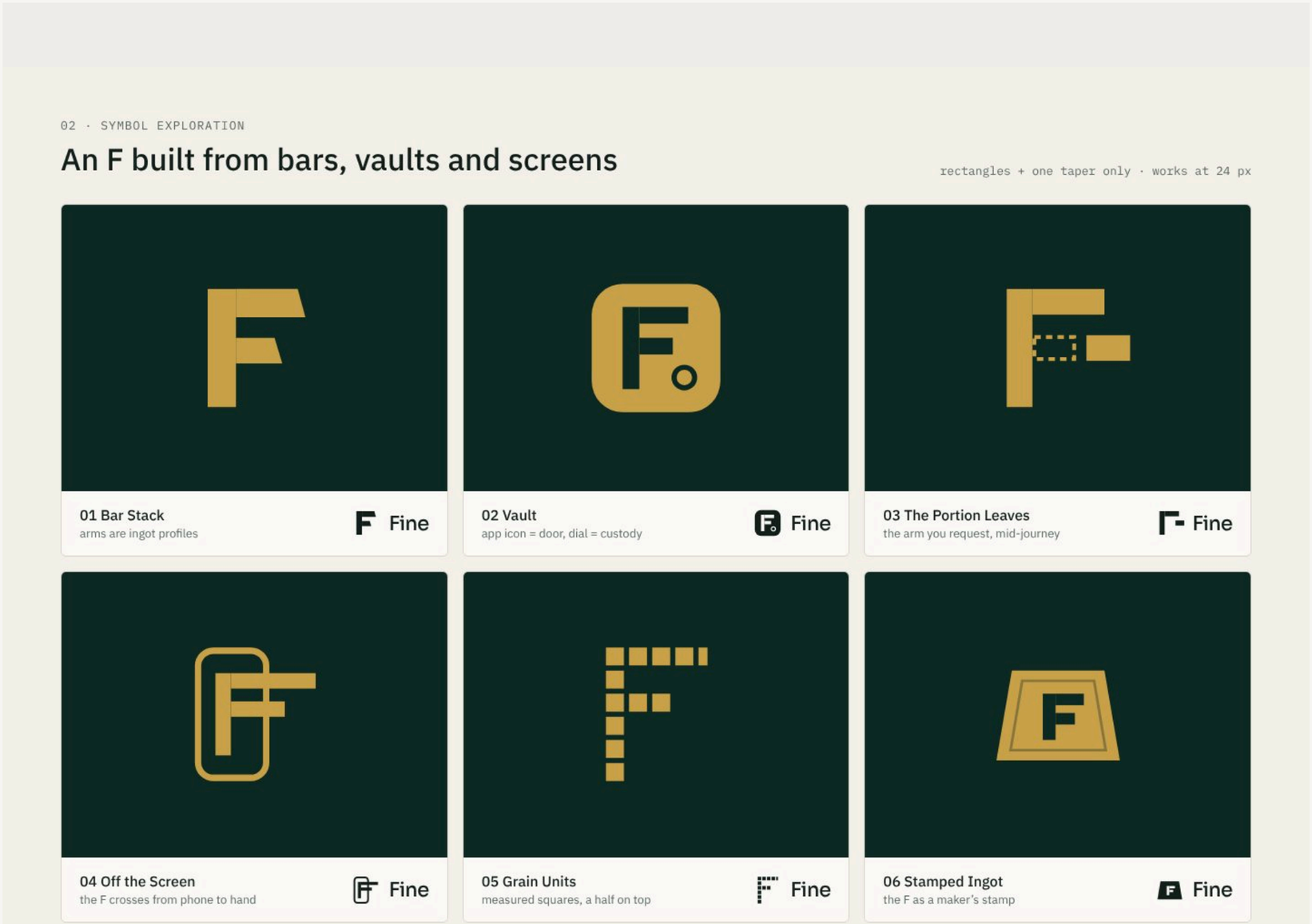
© 2026. All rights reserved.

PROCESS

Starting wide

I tried nine typefaces for the name, six geometric F marks and three grounds: green, petrol and night blue, each with gold.

None of the geometric marks felt like money you can hold. I went with green and kept looking for the F.



Six geometric F marks

© 2026. All rights reserved.

PROCESS

Separate bars, held together

The idea I kept coming back to was separate bars coming together to build something, like a small holding that grows over time. This board tries it as a mark, a word, an icon and a pattern.



Separate bars come together

© 2026. All rights reserved.

THE MARK

The F, rebuilt

I took the F from Luperca, a free serif. I made the stem 50% heavier so it feels solid and swapped its arms for two gold bars with a real ingot taper.

In two seconds it reads as an F. In three you see two bars docked on a post.



Luperca's F next to the Fine F

© 2026. All rights reserved.

THE WORDMARK

A bar in every letter

Then I took it into every letter. Each serif, each arm and the full stop is a gold bar with a fine carved line around it.

The main logo only shows the F bars and the stop in gold. The other eight appear when the logo moves.

12 · FINE. — CARVED

Every serif, arm and stop is a gold bar, finely carved into the letters

drawn on Luperca proportions



Primary · two bars revealed in gold, the rest hidden in the carving — Fine.



Where the bars hide — 11 bars in five characters



On night blue



84 / 42 / 24 px · one-ink

Carved, with hidden bars

© 2026. All rights reserved.

MOTION

The reveal

The logo animation in six steps: plain capitals, then the carved lines, the stop, the F, all eleven bars, and finally the bars lifting off to show what the letters are made of.



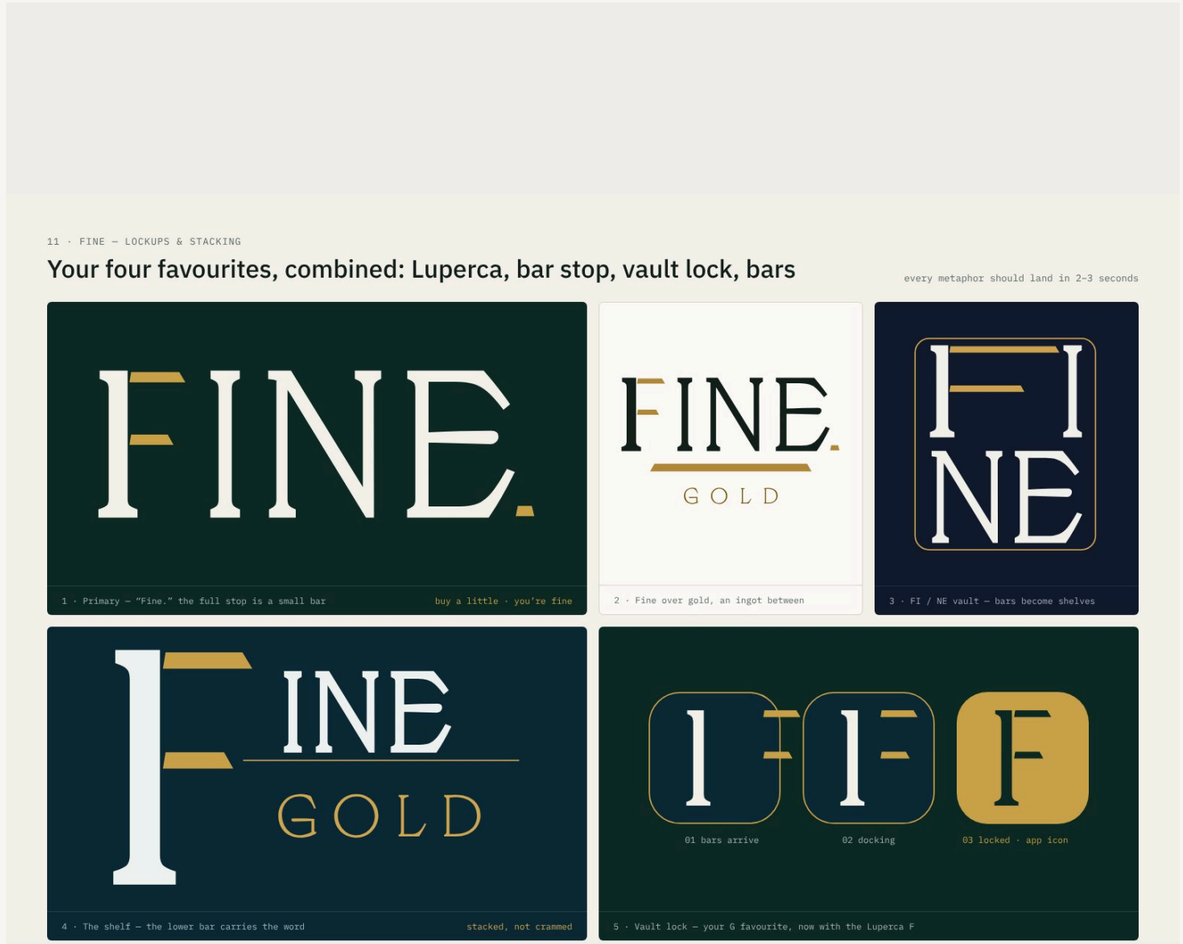
Six steps of the reveal

© 2026. All rights reserved.

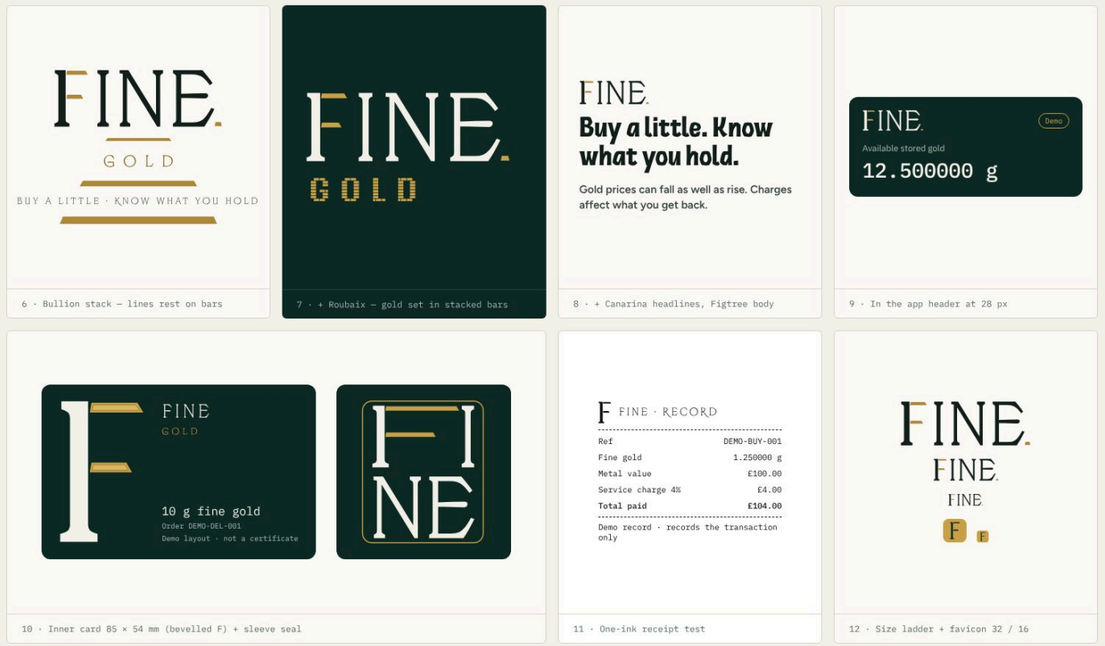
THE WORDMARK

Lockups and stacking

Horizontal, stacked and icon-only versions, on green, paper and night blue. The stacked version keeps the bars lined up from one line to the next.



Lockups



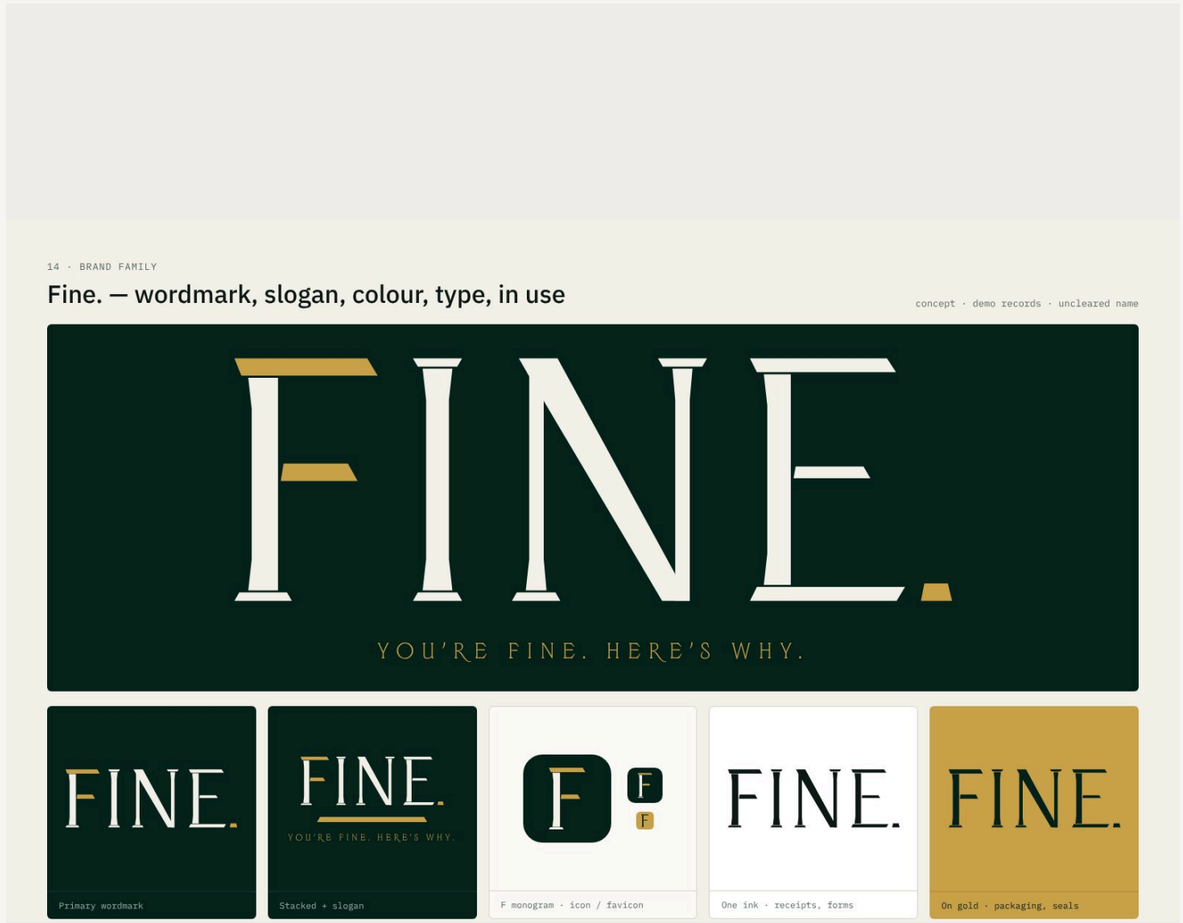
Lockups at small sizes and in the app

© 2026. All rights reserved.

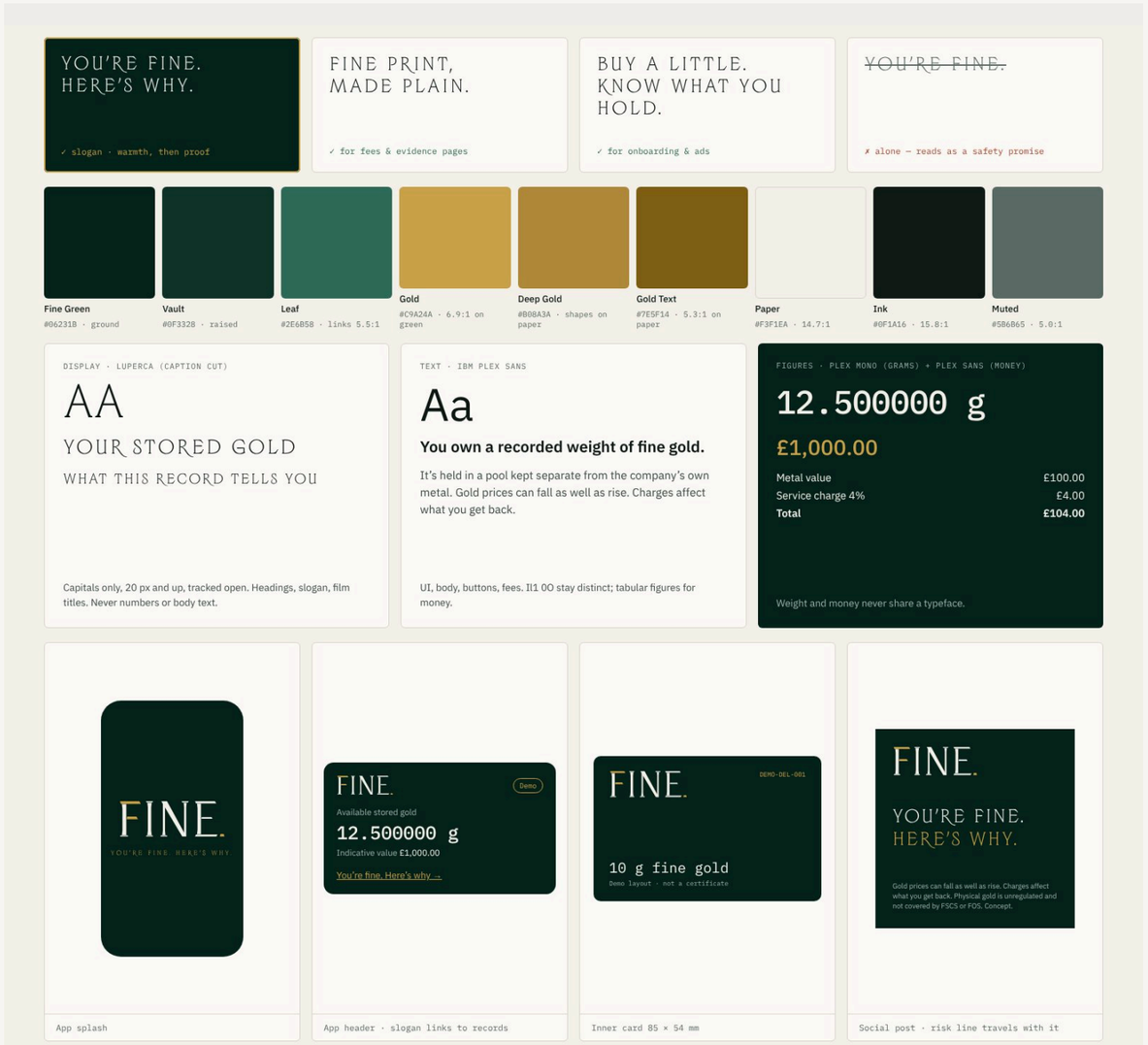
THE SYSTEM

The brand on one sheet

Wordmark, slogan, colour and type together. The slogan is “You’re fine. Here’s why.”, which is what the app should feel like after a purchase.



Wordmark and slogan



Colour, type and the brand in use

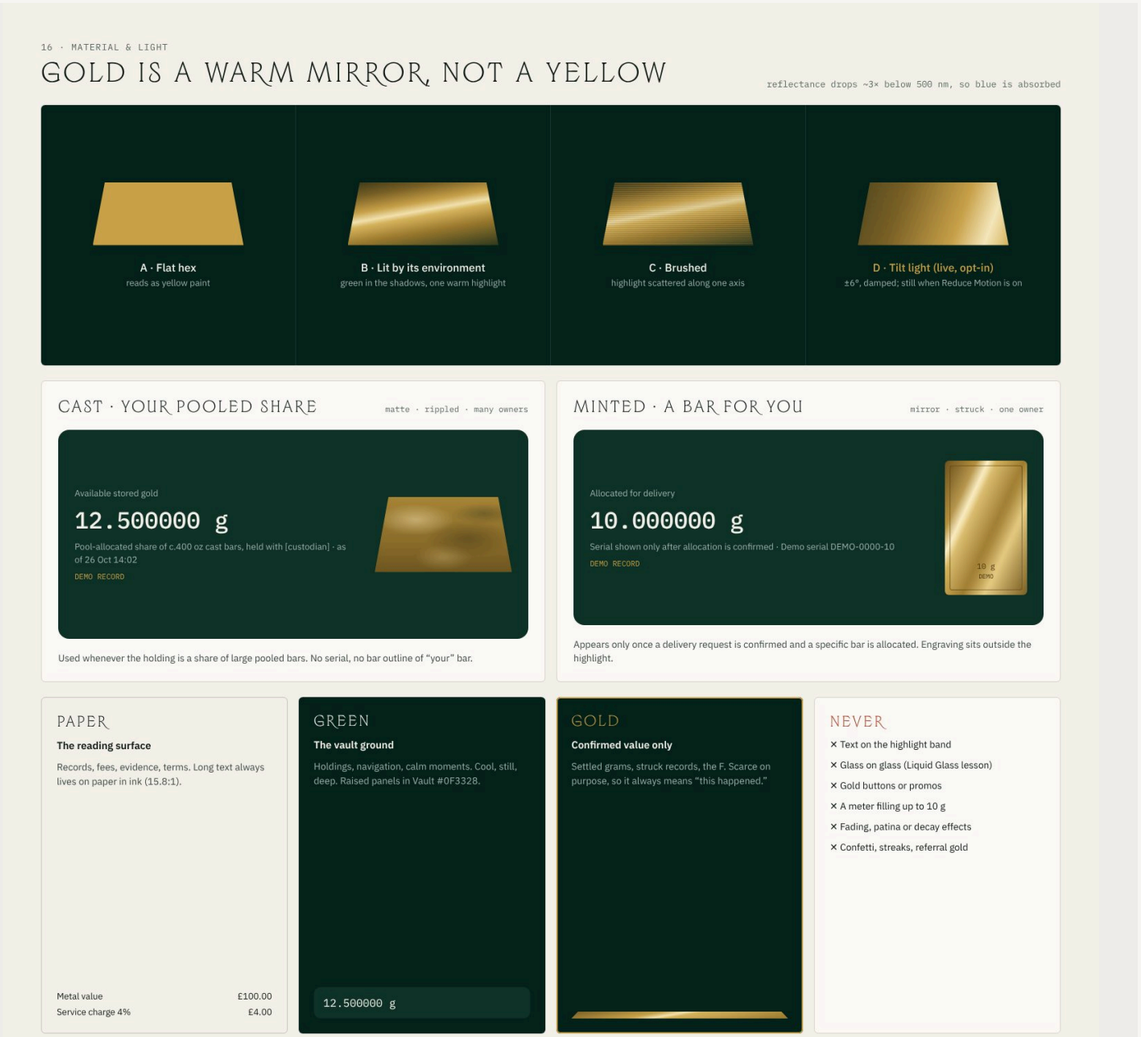
© 2026. All rights reserved.

GOLD AS A MATERIAL

Light, not a flat yellow

I gave the gold one narrow highlight and let the green ground reflect into its darker face. On the phone the highlight follows the tilt, and it's off by default. In print the bars are hot-foil stamped, so real foil catches the light.

What I learned: one strong idea pushed through every letter did more for trust than adding new shapes.

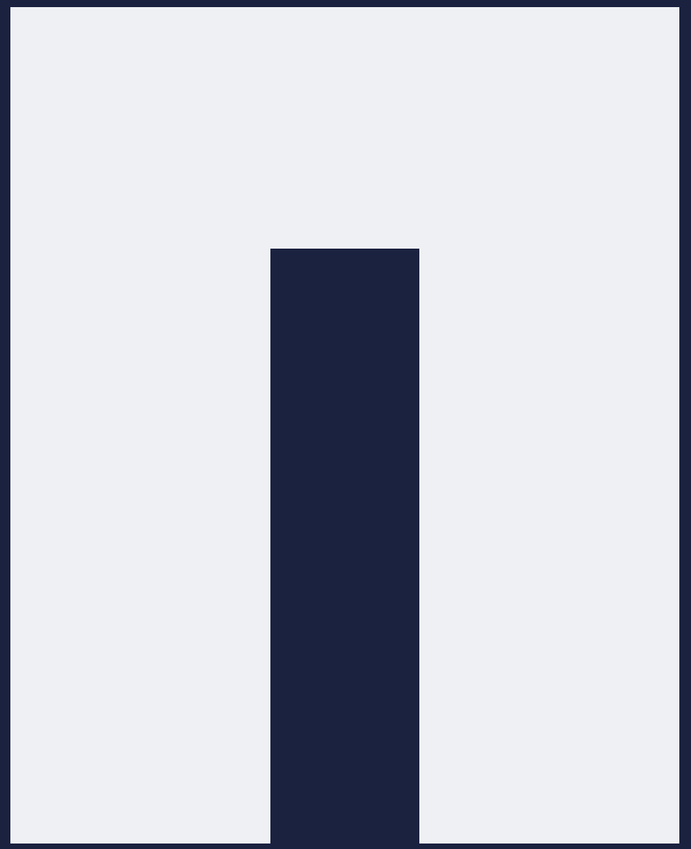


Material and light



The lit wordmark across the brand

© 2026. All rights reserved.



The detail it all grew from: one notcher slot.

04

Notch

A denim trouser label. You measure a pair you already own, and every Notch cut is drawn against it.

notch

BRIEF
Self-initiated

PRODUCT
Three denim cuts and a small hand-printed line

I MADE
Logo, colour, measurement graphics, hangtags, brochure, mailer, catalogue

YEAR
2026

© 2026. All rights reserved.

THE BRIEF

Start from the pair you love

Most people own one pair of jeans that fits. Notch asks you to measure it, then shows each of its cuts against it.

My other two brands are calm, so I wanted colour in this one. A small line of pairs is printed by hand, in a few inks each.



Round one at a glance

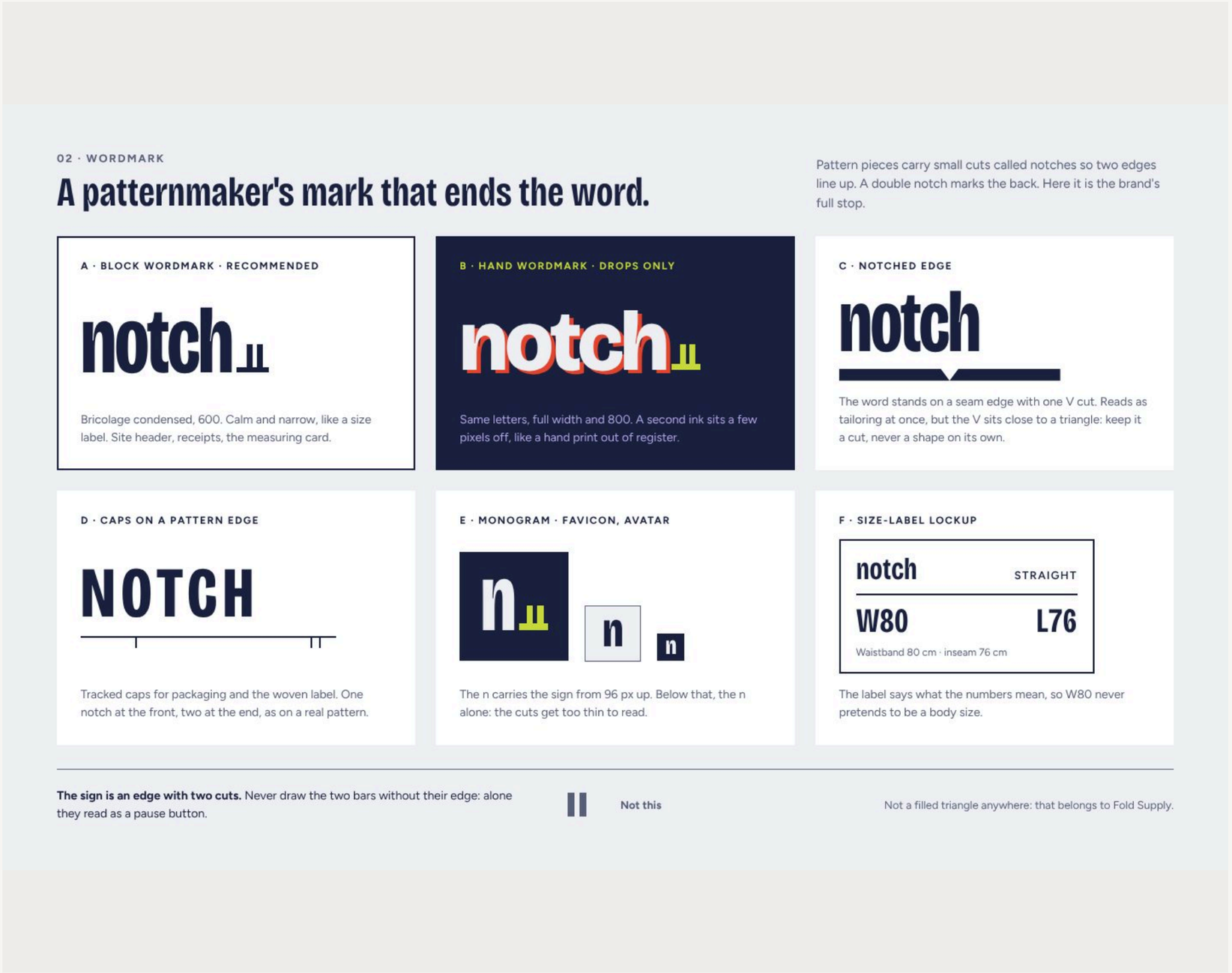
© 2026. All rights reserved.

PROCESS

Round one wasn’t it

My first wordmark used a condensed typeface with a small notch sign at the end. A later version turned the n itself into a squared notch.

I found it boring, so I went back for a second logo round with three different ideas.



Round one wordmarks

© 2026. All rights reserved.

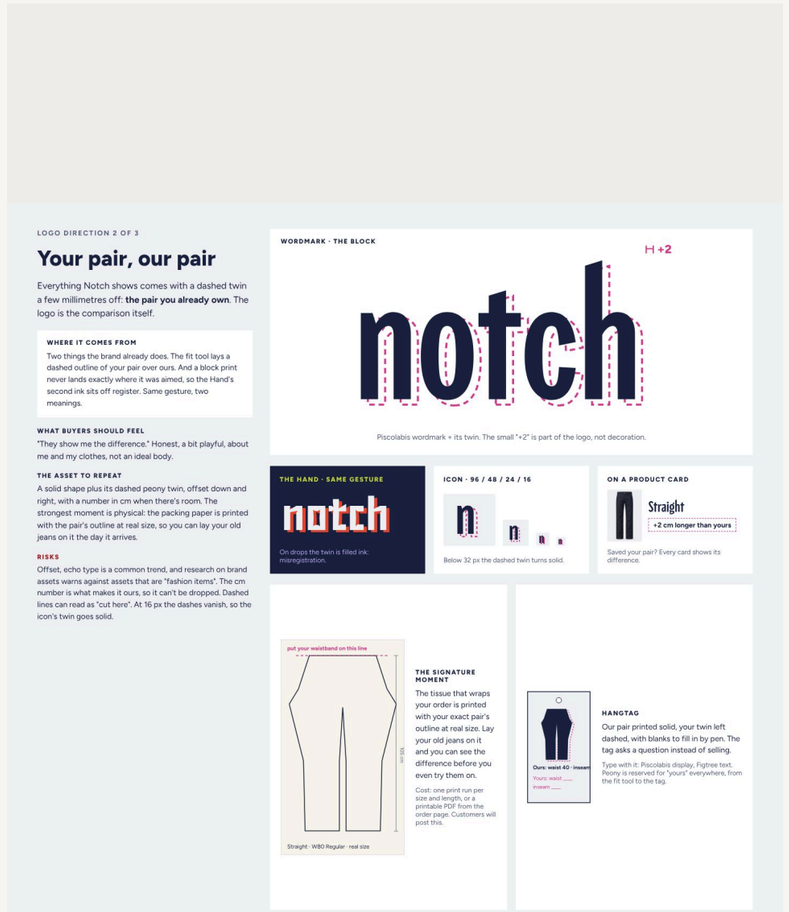
PROCESS

Three directions

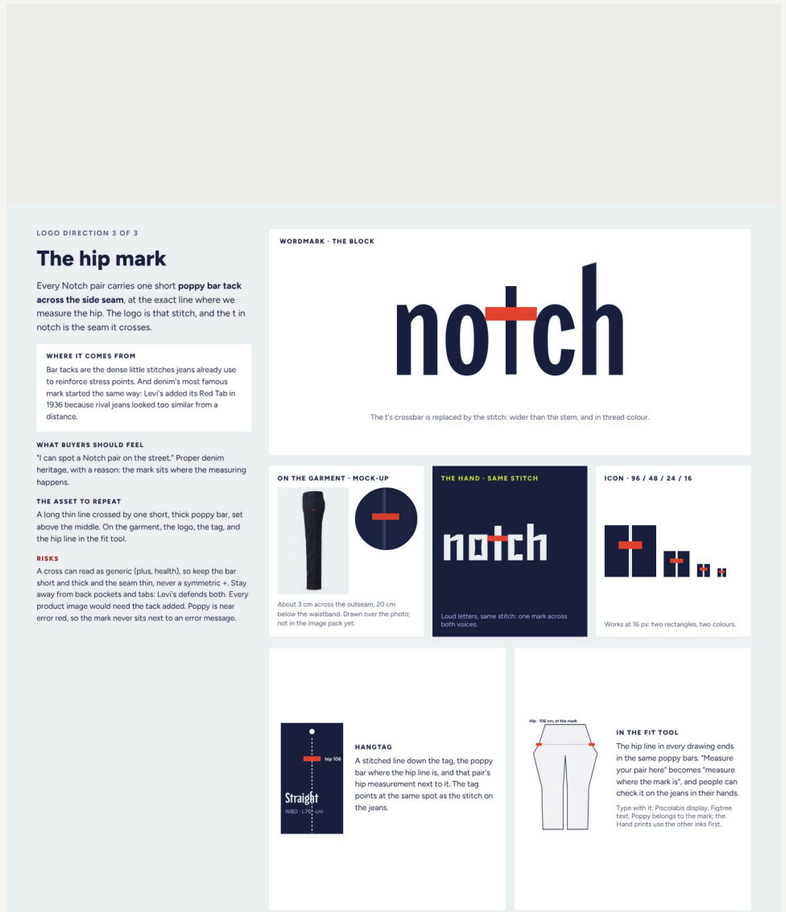
Round two: the letters cut like a paper pattern, a dashed twin showing your pair next to ours, and a bar tack stitched at the hip. I picked the first one.



1 · Cut, not drawn (chosen)



2 · Your pair, our pair



3 · The hip mark

© 2026. All rights reserved.

THE MARK

Cut, not drawn

The letters are die-cut. The o is a hook-hole punch, and the gaps in n, c and h are notcher slots, the narrow 1 : 4 cut a patternmaker bites into card.

On the hangtag the same slots give the length: one for Short, two for Regular, three for Long. Staff can sort a rail by touch.



The chosen logo and its hangtag

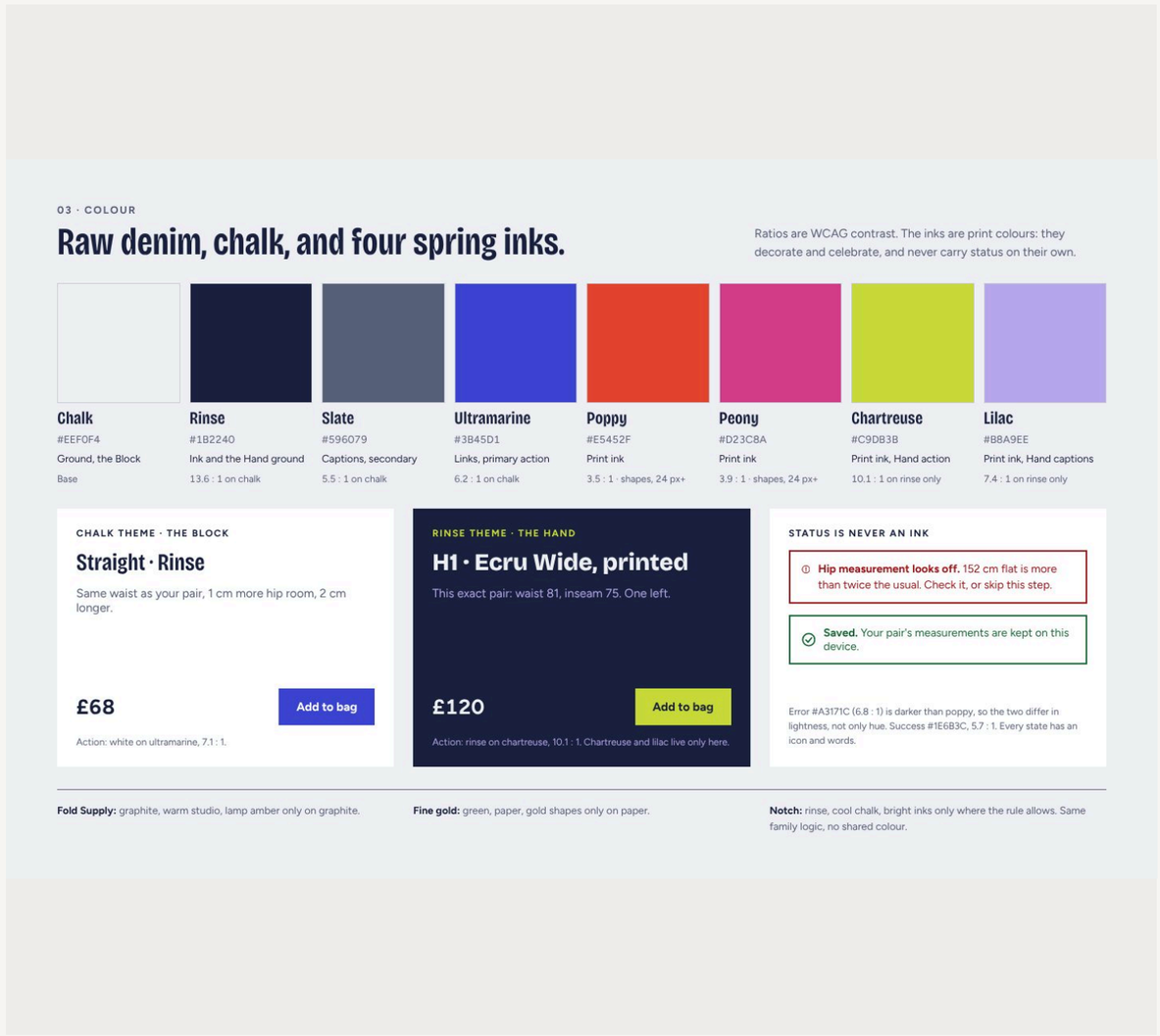
© 2026. All rights reserved.

COLOUR AND MEASURING

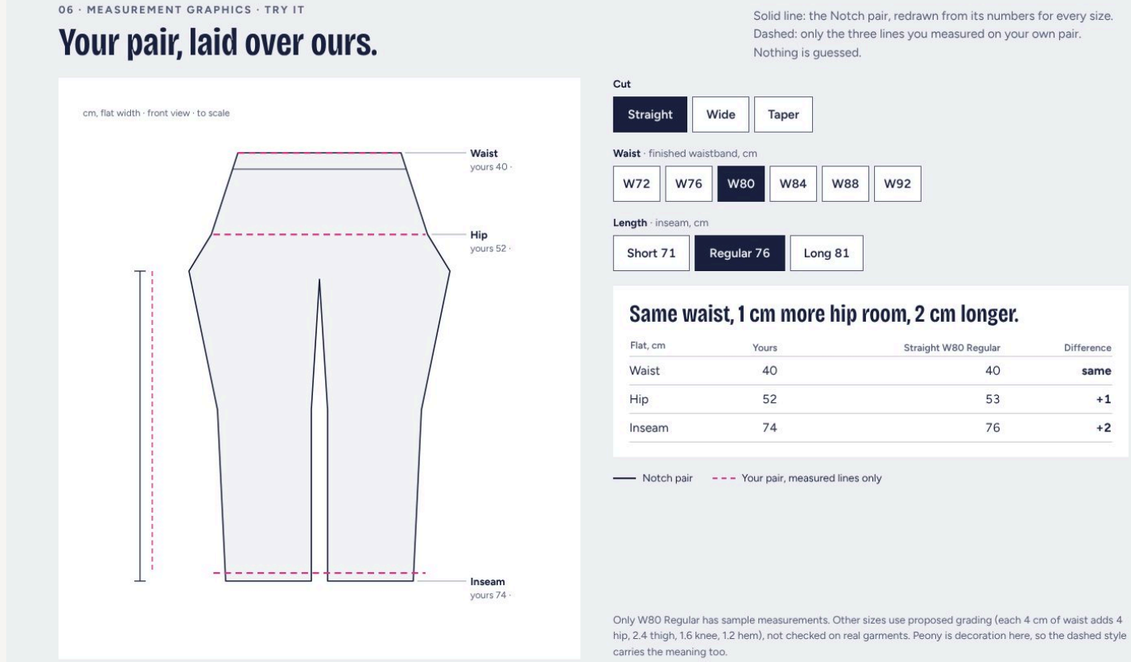
New colours, and a drawing you can trust

I wanted colours I hadn't used for Fold Supply or Fine. Rinse denim and cool chalk do the everyday work. The four inks belong to the printed pairs and never show a status, so an error message is never poppy red.

The measuring drawing is part of the brand too: our pair as a solid line, yours dashed, both to scale.



Colour



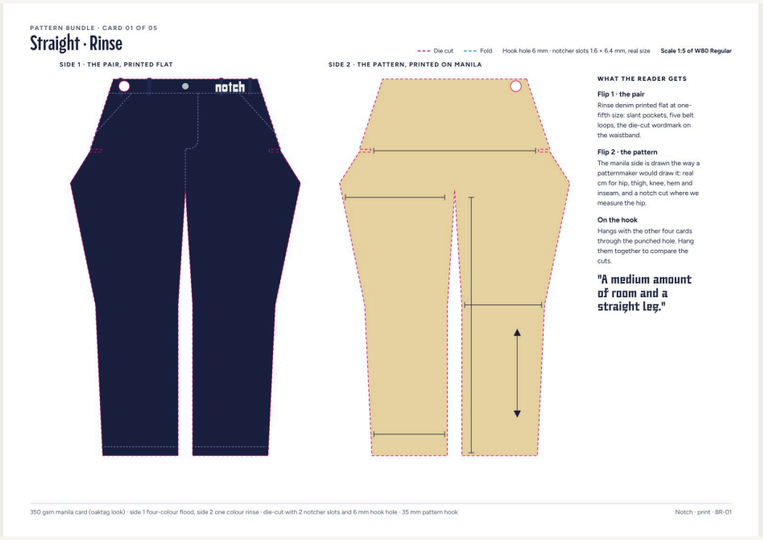
Measurement graphics

© 2026. All rights reserved.

PRINT

The pattern bundle

A brochure made of trouser-shaped cards at 1 : 5, hung on a ring like a real pattern. The front shows the pair, the back shows its pattern on manila card with the real measurements.



Card 01, Straight



Card 02, Wide



Card 04, hand-printed



Mailer pair with cuffs

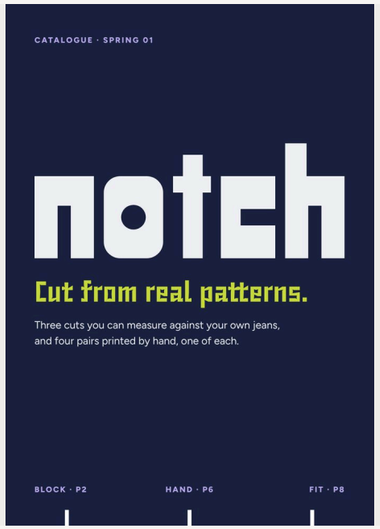
© 2026. All rights reserved.

PRINT

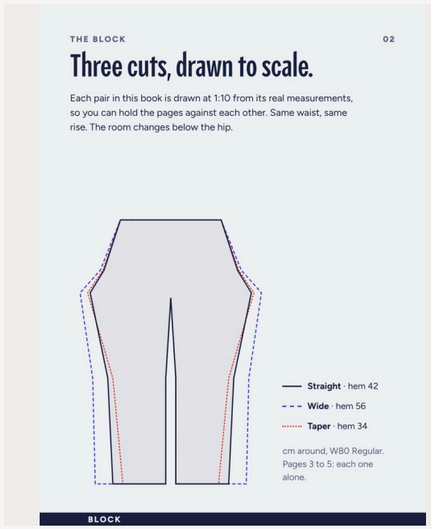
The hem index catalogue

An A5 catalogue cut at three heights, so the bottom edges step like hems. The back cover is stamped and numbered by hand.

What I learned: when I was bored by my own logo, a whole new round was faster than polishing it.



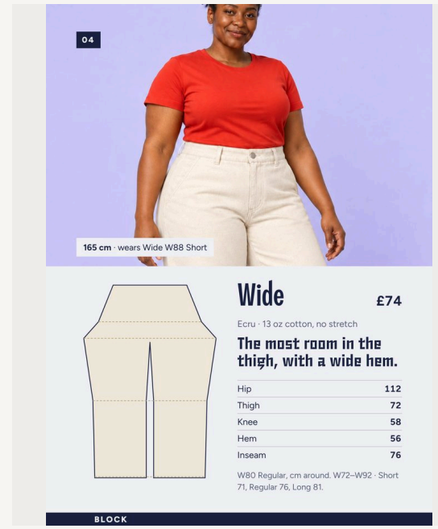
Cover



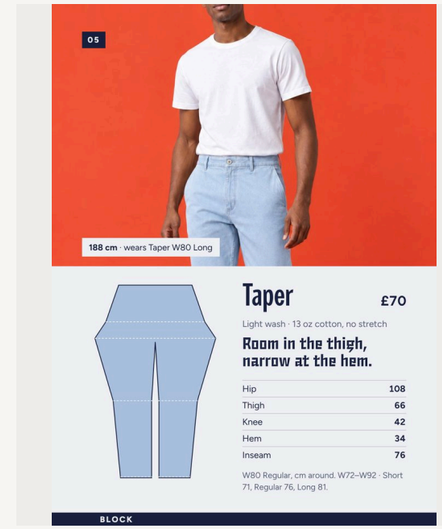
Three cuts to scale



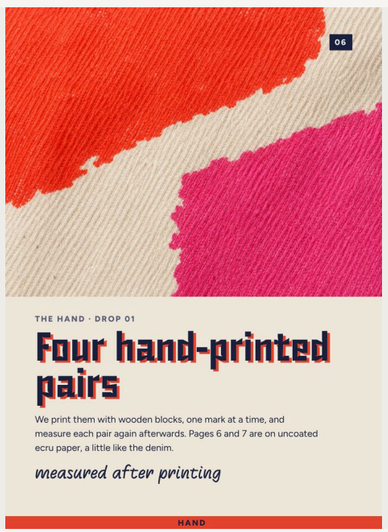
Straight



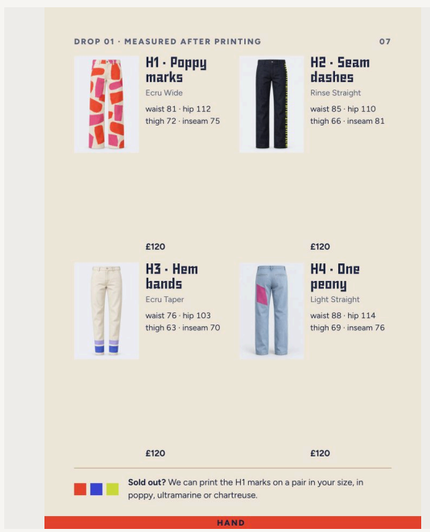
Wide



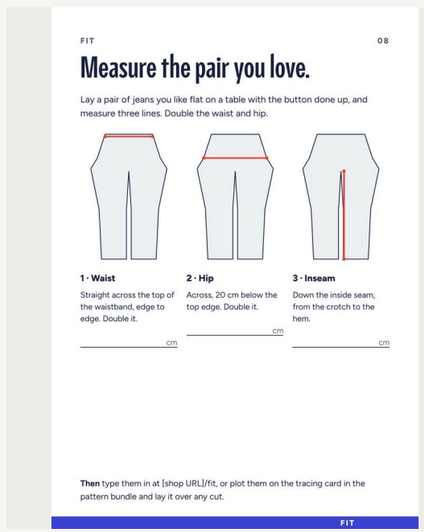
Taper



Hand-printed opener



Drop 01



Measure your pair



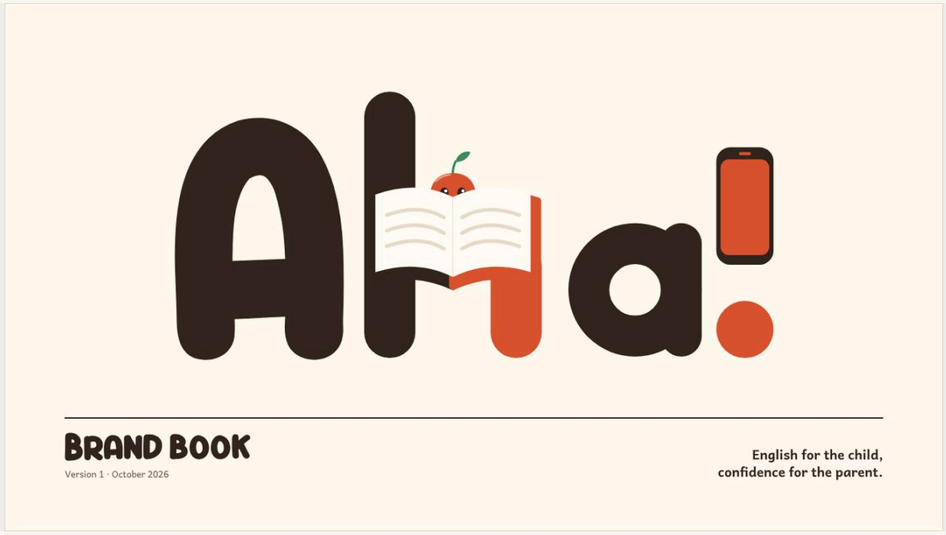
Back cover

© 2026. All rights reserved.

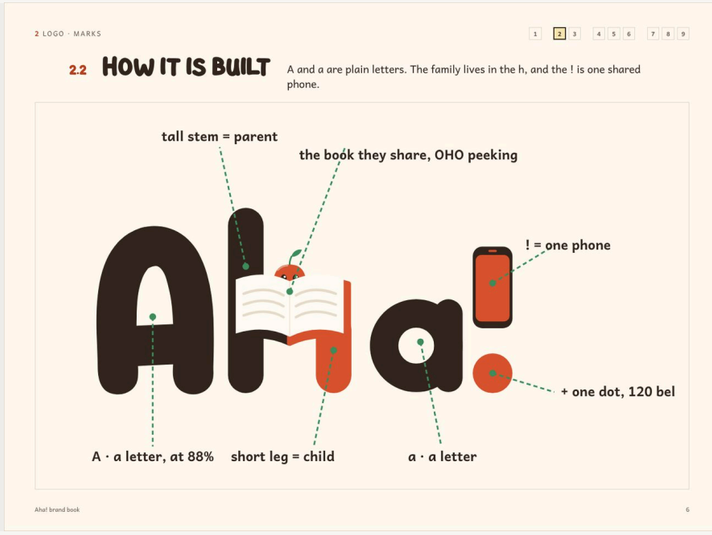
05 · SMALLER STUDIES

Aha!

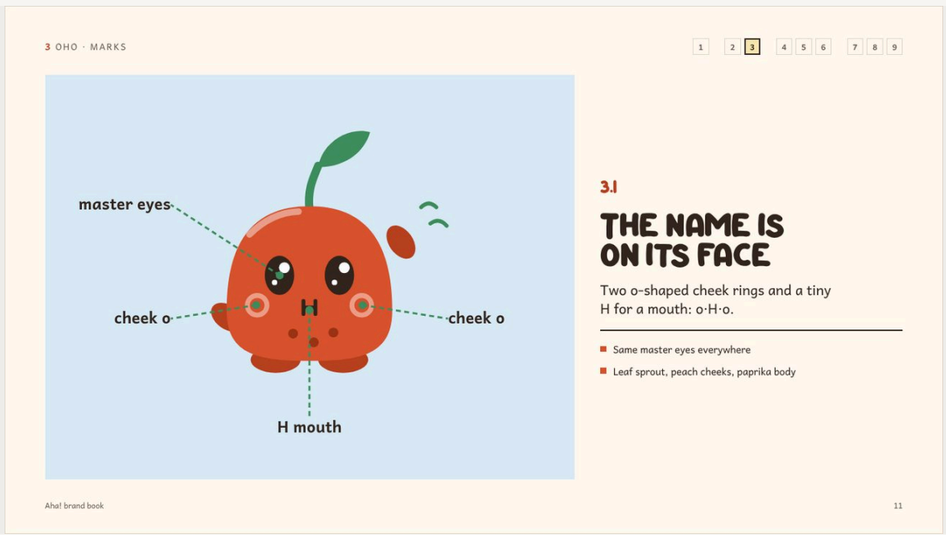
Aha! is a brand for an English-learning app that a parent and child use together, even when the parent doesn't speak English. The mascot, OHO, peeks out of the open book in the logo and sits in the corner of every flashcard. The brand book is 26 pages.



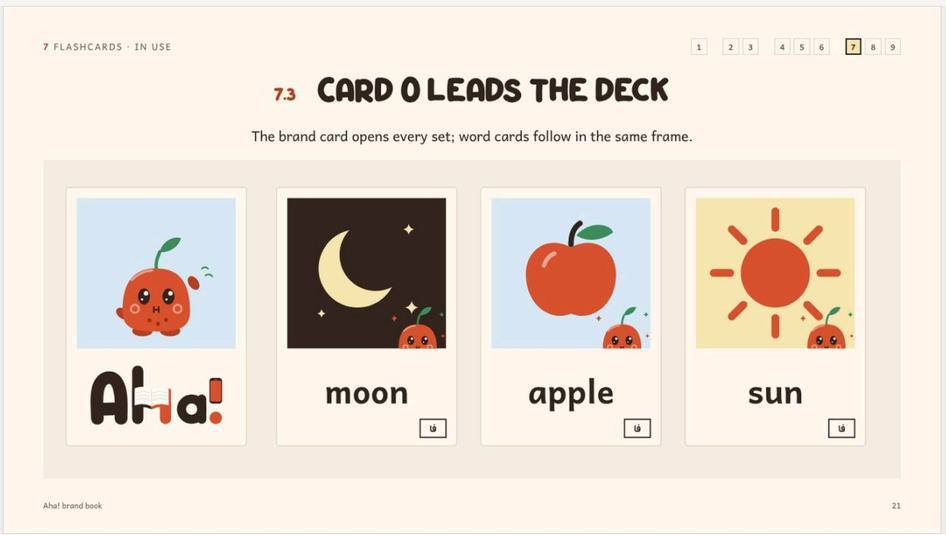
Aha! brand book cover



How the logo is built



OHO, the mascot



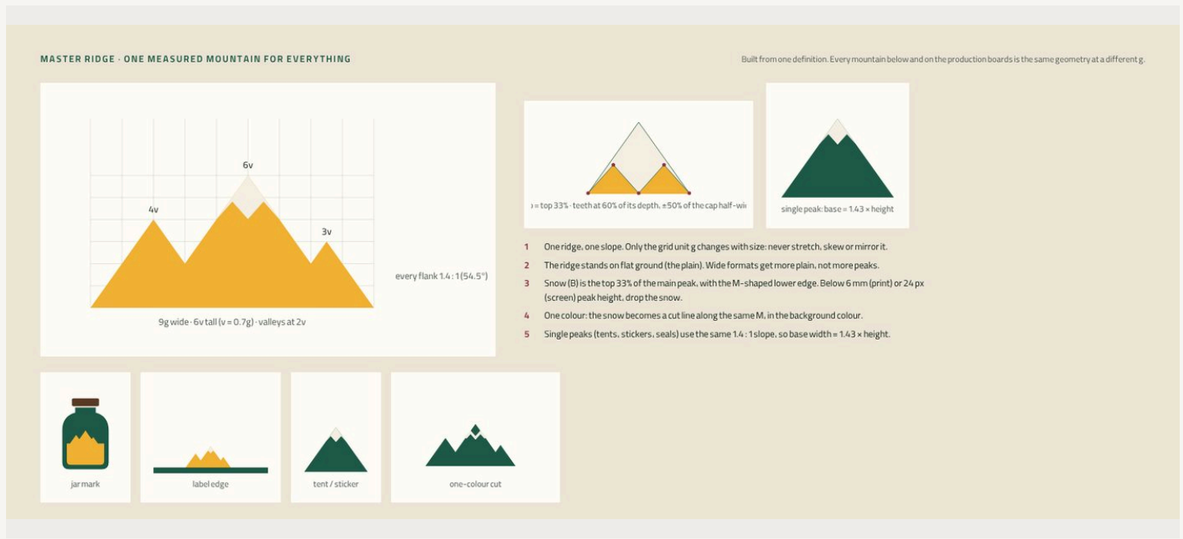
The flashcard deck

© 2026. All rights reserved.

SMALLER STUDIES

A family honey brand

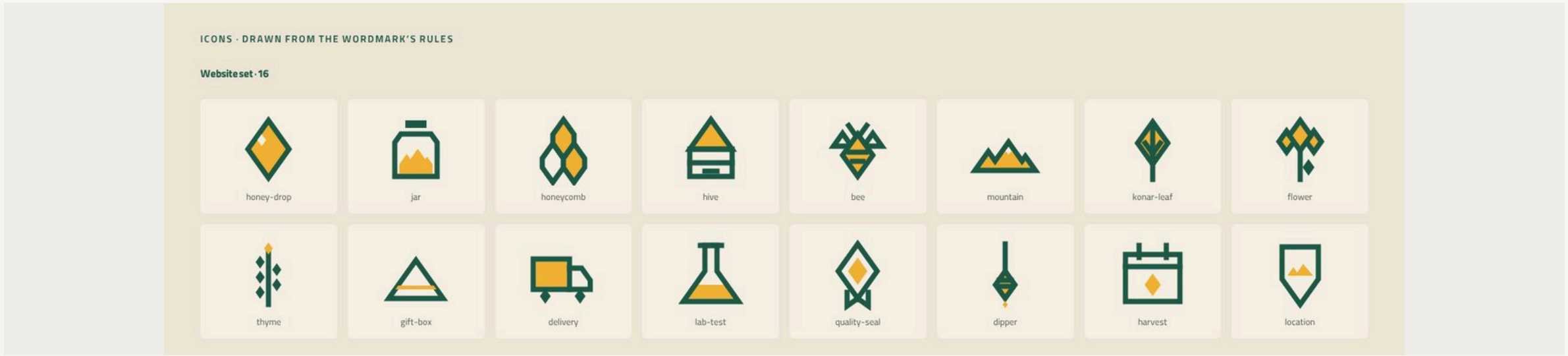
I drew one mountain ridge to a fixed slope of 1.4 : 1. Every mountain in the brand uses it, from the jar mark and the labels to 16 icons and a woven pattern for gift boxes.



One measured ridge



Woven gift pattern



Icon set

© 2026. All rights reserved.

06

What I can make for you

Send me what you sell and who buys it. You get a few routes first, then one identity built out properly.

- Logo or wordmark, with rules for using it
- Icon set drawn to a grid
- Logo motion
- Asset pack in SVG and PNG
- Colour and type system
- Packaging, labels and print
- Brandbook as a PDF or slides

© 2026. All rights reserved.